

- 163.** The man could not buy the handkerchiefs because
 (a) he did not like the handkerchiefs
 (b) his friend did not allow him to buy them
 (c) the shop did not have any handkerchiefs
 (d) he had no money in the purse
- 164.** When he tried to take out the purse, he discovered that
 (a) it was not there (b) it was lost
 (c) it was a new purse (d) it was his friend's purse

PASSAGE 44

A profound terror, increased still by the darkness, the silence and his waking images, froze his heart within him. He almost felt his hair stand on end, when by straining his eyes to their utmost, he perceived through the shadows two faint yellow lights. At first, he attributed these lights to the reflection of his own pupils, but soon the vivid brilliance of the night aided him gradually to distinguish the objects around him in the cave, and he beheld a huge animal lying but two steps from him.

- 165.** The opening of the passage suggests that
 (a) darkness, silence and waking images added to his already being in profound terror
 (b) a profound terror increased the waking images in his frozen heart
 (c) the person was frightened by darkness and silence
 (d) a profound terror was caused in him by the silence and darkness of the night
- 166.** When he perceived through the shadows two faint lights,
 (a) he experienced a great strain
 (b) he felt his hair stand upright
 (c) his eyes felt strained to their utmost
 (d) his pupils dilated
- 167.** The person in the story
 (a) imagined that he saw an animal
 (b) could not recognise the animal
 (c) saw the animal by chance
 (d) expected to see the animal

PASSAGE 45

We are tempted to assume that technological progress is real progress and that material success is the criterion of civilisation. If the Eastern people become fascinated by machines and techniques and use them, as Western nations do, to build huge industrial organisations and large military establishments, they will get involved in power politics and drift into the danger of death. Scientific and technological civilisation brings great opportunities and great rewards, but also great risks and temptations. Science and technology are neither good nor bad. They are not to be tabooed but tamed and assigned their proper place. They become dangerous only if they become idols.

- 168.** According to the author, people think that real progress lies in
 (a) material success and technological growth
 (b) imitating Western nations
 (c) having large industries and political power
 (d) taking risks and facing temptations
- 169.** According to the author, science and technology should be
 (a) tabooed and eliminated from life
 (b) used in a controlled and careful manner
 (c) encouraged and liberally used
 (d) made compulsory in education
- 170.** From the passage, one gathers that the Eastern people must
 (a) appreciate scientific achievements
 (b) build huge industrial organisations
 (c) avoid being controlled by machines and techniques of industrial production
 (d) be fascinated by machines
- 171.** According to the author, science and technology are
 (a) totally harmless
 (b) extremely dangerous
 (c) to be treated as idols
 (d) useful, if they are not worshipped blindly

PASSAGE 46

It is not luck but labour that makes men. Luck, says an American writer, is ever waiting for something to turn up; labour with keen eyes and strong will always turns up something. Luck lies in bed and wishes the postman would bring him news of a legacy; labour turns out at six and with busy pen and ringing hammer lays the foundation of competence. Luck whines, labour watches. Luck relies on chance; labour on character. Luck slips downwards to self-indulgence; labour strides upwards and aspires to independence. The conviction, therefore, is extending that diligence is the mother of good luck; in other words, that a man's success in life will be proportionate to his efforts, to his industry, to his attention to small things.

- 172.** Which one of the following statements sums up the meaning of the passage?
 (a) Luck waits without exertion but labour exerts without waiting
 (b) Luck waits and complains without working while labour achieves success although it complains
 (c) Luck often ends in defeat but labour produces luck
 (d) Luck is self-indulgent but labour is selfless
- 173.** Which one of the following statements is true about the passage?
 (a) Luck is necessary for success
 (b) Success depends on hard work and attention to details
 (c) Expectation of good luck always meets with disappointment
 (d) Success is exactly proportionate to hard work only

- 174.** “..... labour turns out at six and with busy pen and ringing hammer lays the foundation of competence.” This statement means

- (a) hard work of all kinds makes people efficient and skilled
- (b) the labour lays the foundation of the building
- (c) the writer and the labourer are the true eyes of the society
- (d) there is no worker who works so hard as the labourer who begins his day at six in the morning

PASSAGE 47

The avowed purpose of the exact sciences is to establish complete intellectual control over experience in terms of precise rules which can be formally set out and empirically tested. Could that ideal be fully achieved, all truth and all error could henceforth be ascribed to an exact theory of the universe, while we who accept this theory would be relieved of any occasion for exercising our personal judgement. We should only have to follow the rules faithfully. Classical mechanics approaches this ideal so closely that it is often thought to have achieved it. But this leaves out of account the element of personal judgement involved in applying the formulae of mechanics to the facts of experience.

- 175.** The purpose of the exact sciences is to
- (a) form opinions about our experience
 - (b) formulate principles which will help us to exercise our personal judgement
 - (c) assert our intellectual superiority
 - (d) make formal and testable rules which can help verify experience

- 176.** An exact theory of the universe is
- (a) not desirable
 - (b) improbable
 - (c) possible
 - (d) yet to be made

- 177.** In exact sciences,
- (a) personal judgements are set aside in favour of a mechanical theory
 - (b) one does not find answers to all questions and problems
 - (c) one reposes faith in actual experience
 - (d) one interprets the universe according to one's wish

- 178.** Classical mechanics
- (a) has formulated precise rules based on experience
 - (b) has gained intellectual control over the world
 - (c) has formulated an exact theory of the universe
 - (d) just falls short of achieving intellectual control over experience

ANSWERS

Check Your Comprehension Skill

1	c	2	b	3	a	4	d	5	d	6	b	7	b	8	b	9	d	10	b
11	b	12	c	13	d	14	b	15	d	16	d	17	c	18	c	19	d	20	d
21	c	22	a	23	d	24	b	25	c	26	d	27	b	28	c	29	c	30	b
31	b	32	c	33	c	34	c	35	d	36	d	37	a	38	c	39	c	40	a
41	c	42	c	43	a	44	c	45	c	46	c	47	c	48	b	49	d	50	c
51	b	52	d	53	b	54	d	55	c	56	a	57	b	58	c	59	d	60	b
61	a	62	c	63	c	64	a	65	b	66	c	67	a	68	d	69	d	70	a
71	a	72	c	73	a	74	c	75	c	76	b	77	d	78	c	79	d	80	c
81	b	82	c	83	a	84	c	85	a	86	d	87	d	88	c	89	c	90	b
91	a	92	c	93	c	94	d	95	a	96	d	97	d	98	d	99	c	100	b
101	d	102	c	103	b	104	b												

Questions from CDS Exam (2012-16)

1	c	2	d	3	a	4	b	5	c	6	d	7	a	8	c	9	b	10	c
11	d	12	c	13	d	14	a	15	c	16	b	17	c	18	b	19	a	20	b
21	c	22	b	23	b	24	d	25	d	26	b	27	d	28	b	29	c	30	a
31	d	32	c	33	c	34	b	35	c	36	c	37	b	38	d	39	c	40	a
41	d	42	b	43	c	44	a	45	d	46	c	47	b	48	a	49	b	50	a
51	c	52	b	53	a	54	b	55	b	56	c	57	d	58	c	59	a	60	b
61	c	62	c	63	b	64	b	65	b	66	a	67	d	68	c	69	b	70	d
71	a	72	c	73	d	74	b	75	a	76	b	77	d	78	d	79	b	80	c
81	c	82	c	83	c	84	c	85	a	86	b	87	c	88	d	89	a	90	a
91	c	92	a	93	b	94	d	95	a	96	d	97	c	98	b	99	b	100	a
101	c	102	b	103	b	104	c	105	b	106	a	107	b	108	d	109	d	110	d
111	c	112	a	113	b	114	b	115	d	116	c	117	b	118	b	119	b	120	d
121	c	122	b	123	d	124	c	125	d	126	a	127	c	128	b	129	a	130	d
131	c	132	a	133	a	134	b	135	d	136	a	137	b	138	c	139	b	140	d
141	a	142	c	143	b	144	c	145	c	146	b	147	a	148	c	149	b	150	d
151	c	152	d	153	d	154	b	155	c	156	d	157	a	158	b	159	b	160	b
161	b	162	c	163	d	164	d	165	a	166	c	167	a	168	a	169	b	170	c
171	d	172	d	173	b	174	a	175	b	176	b	177	a	178	a				

EXPLANATIONS

Check Your Comprehension Skill

1. (c) In an affluent society, many people prefer to work shorter hours because they want time to carry out other activities.
2. (b) Domestic chores are too demanding.
3. (a) Robots are used in mines and factories to perform the hazardous tasks.
4. (d) It depends on the number of people who require it.
5. (d) In the writer's opinion, the energy crisis will remain with us for an almost indefinite period of time.
6. (b) 'So fragile a base' refers to the uncertainty about the flow of Arab oil.
7. (b) The type of writing in the passage could be called scientific.
8. (b) Death is a natural phenomenon because it is as natural as the fall of leaves or fruits from a tree.
9. (d) The author wants to show that death occurs with the achievement of fullness.
10. (b) Here, option (b) is appropriate.
11. (b) Here, the author's opinion is that one should be different from others.
12. (c) To establish a different image.
13. (d) According to the author, one should try to get noticed by being innovative.
14. (b) The author had been a comedy writer.
15. (d) Here, option (d) is correct.
16. (d) Here, option (d) is correct.
17. (c) Wind power is economically viable on long-term basis is the correct statement.
18. (c) The phrase 'almost inevitably' means invariably.
19. (d) The bitterness of conflict has been toned down because of the writer being quite close to the Englishmen.
20. (d) Because the writer was popular among the masses.
21. (c) Because English is the most important language of the world.
22. (a) The speakers of every language consider their language as the most important one.
23. (d) The writer's evaluation of the importance of the English language is based on objective criteria.
24. (b) The main reason of frustration is that the young generation is unemployed.
25. (c) The enormous responsibility to comprehend the problems of the young generation lies with the sociologists.
26. (d) The increase in violence in our society is the result of frustration in life.
27. (b) Strive for freedom is the correct answer.
28. (c) A worm first tries to move out of the glass jar.
29. (c) Here, option (c) is correct.
30. (b) Matter constantly changes shape as it has an urge to be free.
31. (b) Topography deals with the description of features of a place.
32. (c) Formal instruction is about a regular education at school.
33. (c) Here, option (c) is correct.
34. (c) Here, option (c) correctly explains the statement.
35. (d) The mate shall stop guessing about your feelings when you talk openly to him.
36. (d) If you are honest with yourself, you can talk openly and honestly to your mate.
37. (a) You should take time off to be alone so that you can talk to yourself.
38. (c) No architect plans without assessing the present situation because change is impossible otherwise.
39. (c) According to the author, meetings are a form of playing elaborate games.
40. (a) The correct option is (a).
41. (c) The author believes in the sanctity of holding meeting for collective opinion.
42. (c) The traditional image of a lion is that he is wise, gentle and brave.
43. (a) The writer was extremely frightened so he used this statement.
44. (c) The lion is described as a beast with a sense of wrath.
45. (c) The author's friend took him away from the public walk in order to avoid a person who was following them.
46. (c) Here, option (c) is the correct answer.
47. (c) The author was panicked at the sudden appearance of a person which he did not like.
48. (b) The ceremony of the solitary retreat was observed by every boy and every girl in some tribes.
49. (d) The purpose of the retreat was to secure the aid of a spirit for oneself.
50. (c) The way to perform the vigil was to fast and wait alone.
51. (b) Because the sound of the boy's scream surpassed in the gale.
52. (d) The boy was walking behind his parents while he was struck by the gale.
53. (b) The parents discovered the mishap only when the dog barked furiously.
54. (d) The dabbawallahs came into existence as a consequence of Mumbai's overcrowding.
55. (c) The people of Mumbai could go home to take lunch in the past.
56. (a) Option (a) i.e. objective is the correct answer.
57. (b) During the winter, common birds in India come down to the foothills.
58. (c) Because of bad weather birds get delayed in migration.

59. (d) Mostly the birds make their long journey in the darkness.
60. (b) Option (b) is the correct answer.
61. (a) The likely reason is that in order to sell books, he has to tell lies.
62. (c) The author liked to buy a lot of books at auctions.
63. (c) Option (c) is the correct statement.
64. (a) 'I scraped through my BA examination' means that the author passed it with great difficulty.
65. (b) He is highly critical and also sarcastic about it.
66. (c) Walking is recommended as it is not very strenuous.
67. (a) The chances of a heart attack are decreased by walking.
68. (d) Strokes occur because of the bursting of blood vessels.
69. (d) Option (d) is the correct answer.
70. (a) The correct option is (a).
71. (a) The enemy could be cheated easily.
72. (c) Here, leopards is the right answer.
73. (a) Tigers body parts have a value in traditional Chinese medicine.
74. (c) The dangerous groups that prey on are illegal hunters and traditional apothecaries.
75. (c) Sabu wanted to produce a sequel to the Thief of Baghdad.
76. (b) Abu emerges as a benevolent hero in his new incarnation.
77. (d) Sabu's dream came true because his daughter has continued the story of Abu.
78. (c) The author compares the telephone with a pest which creates troubles and destroys our spirit.
79. (d) Waiting for an expected call makes us feel nervous and worried.
80. (c) Here, option (c) is the correct answer.
81. (b) There are several types of proteins which carry out specific tasks.
82. (c) Proteins are classified according to their functions.
83. (a) The function of the enzymes is to direct chemical reactions in body cells.
84. (c) The author suggests that his mother was different from his father.
85. (a) It means that her face clearly showed her feelings.
86. (d) The mother views were based on ethical judgements strongly.
87. (d) According to the author, we must say *Please* as it is a civilised custom.
88. (c) The writer thinks that courtesies make life pleasant.
89. (c) Please and *Thank you* should be used by everybody.
90. (b) Because the author recognised the need for respecting the privacy of her daughter.
91. (a) Openly reciting the poems written by the author.
92. (c) The correct option is (c) here.
93. (c) Humming birds get their names due to the humming noise made by them.
94. (d) Iridescent means glittering.
95. (a) 'Bill' in the passage refers to the humming bird's beak.
96. (d) Option (d) is the correct answer.
97. (d) Child labour is the biggest concern for the whole world.
98. (d) Child labour hinders a child's physical, mental and moral development.
99. (c) Poverty is the main cause of child labour.
100. (b) Bird watching is also referred as birding.
101. (d) 'Traipse' is the correct option.
102. (c) House crow is the right answer.
103. (b) Many people don't like bird watching as they have to wake up at 4 am to watch birds.
104. (b) Beady eyes means watchful eyes.

Questions from CDS Exam (2012-2016)

1. (c) With regard to 'journey' it can be said that a pleasant journey is being referred here.
2. (d) Option (d) is clearly written and hence, the obvious choice.
3. (a) Provisions means mainly food and fresh water.
4. (b) 'Farthing' is a unit of money and in the passage captain was not willing to receive any money from the author as a friendly gesture. Farthing means -A coin formerly used in Great Britain worth one fourth of a penny.
5. (c) The passage shows relationship of author and captain in a positive light.
6. (d) The children think that the Sun and the Moon are moving round the Earth.
7. (a) The early ideas of man were wrong as man did not use the telescope for accurate observations.
8. (c) Option (c) is true with reference to passage. Travelling and exploring is given in the passage as methods for the gaining knowledge.
9. (b) As mentioned in the passage, "They naturally flat". Believing naturally means to believe what we see.
10. (c) Option (c) shows the maximum effect of snow on the feet of the author.
11. (d) The man experienced genuine surprise when he discovered that his hands could not clutch, that there was neither bend nor feeling in the fingers.
12. (c) The man was unable to clutch the dog as his hands got frozen.
13. (d) Even though George was not in town for a long time, station master who most probably would be the part of the same small rural community did not notice his absence from the village.
14. (a) George was over possessed by his success and had created the illusion that everyone in town would come to receive him as people usually do for a successful man.

15. (c) As the passage mentions that his success went in his head so in all probability it was the reason of his inflated expectations. Proper word for it is 'pride'.
16. (b) Only thing that can be associated with his success is his looks with a new suit and a bulky suitcase.
17. (c) Option (c) is correct.
18. (b) It is clearly found in passage that 'The new hazards are neither local nor brief'.
19. (a) Only option (a).
20. (b) There is no special mention of developing countries in the passage regarding farming, it is not given in passage that modern farming methods should be given up. Passage only details the harmful effects of the monocultures.
21. (c) Option (c) seems to be the point author wants to make through the passage linking it with monocultures.
22. (b) Mr Tagde did not sit down because he was in a defiant mood.
23. (b) He would not withdraw the report because it was an accurate report.
24. (d) It can be inferred from the last sentence of the passage that the Principal was unhappy because he did not want to expel the boy.
25. (d) The wind that blew on the night was sharp.
26. (b) The younger woman was carrying the dog as a fashion.
27. (d) The conductor was unfriendly and malicious.
28. (b) The sentence gives us an idea of an unbearable cold night.
29. (c) Option (c) is correct.
30. (a) The passage clearly indicates that the girl was clever and brave.
31. (d) Sound the horn is the correct answer.
32. (c) The writer suggests the importance and utility of portable telephones.
33. (c) It means that the author visited several property dealers without any success.
34. (b) The author was an independent writer.
35. (c) Answer can be inferred after reading the passage that single jobless woman find it difficult to rent a house.
36. (c) Martin played his little tricks because his son got pleasure from them.
37. (b) It is a mask looking like the head of a dragon with its tongue hanging out.
38. (d) The father and son rolled with laughter after the father removed the mask.
39. (c) Galelio made several telescopes as the earlier ones were not powerful enough.
40. (a) 'His heart leaped with joy' means his heart was filled with happiness of success.
41. (d) The author wants us to know that his father loved teaching.
42. (b) The author often felt embarrassed by the behaviour of his father because he taught even at odd places.
43. (c) As per the generation of the writer's father, education was an exploration of the world of imagination.
44. (a) From the passage, it is clear that the author loved and admired his father.
45. (d) They were looking for marks left by the tiger's prey.
46. (c) Mothi began to scream when he came face to face with the tiger.
47. (b) In the passage, 'kill' means an animal killed by the tiger.
48. (a) The jungle was quiet before Mothi screamed.
49. (b) Because he was afraid that the narrator would become very tired.
50. (a) The narrator wanted to shoot the leopard.
51. (c) The poor farmers in Bengal took up indigo cultivation as they were forced to do so.
52. (b) Britishers started purchasing land in India and forced Indian farmers to cultivate indigo.
53. (a) Indigo export was profitable for the British settlers as they had no competitors.
54. (b) The rhinos rush to attack when they smell human scent.
55. (b) When the author saw the rhino for the first time, he was frightened.
56. (c) The author could not take the photographs of the rhinos because he was frightened and it did not occur to him that he had a chance to do so.
57. (d) The young man was well-dressed because he wanted to impress the salesmen.
58. (c) The salesmen in the shop are described as people who pay attention to only rich customers.
59. (a) The young man moved to the hosiery section because he was not interested in purchasing anything.
60. (b) The manager asked the young man what he wanted because the salesman had drawn his attention to the indifferent attitude of the young man.
61. (c) The young man left without making purchases because he had come only to make a point about the indifferent attitude of the salesmen towards casually dressed customers.
62. (c) The prisoner had been punished for robbery.
63. (b) The crime had been committed three years earlier.
64. (b) The warden slumped forward with a dull thud.
65. (b) Option (b) is correct.
66. (a) The author is of the opinion that nationalism makes people self-centered and self-conceited.
67. (d) Evils of narrow and aggressive nationalism incorporates the central theme of the passage.
68. (c) Option (c) is correct.
69. (b) Cornelius lay half-asleep at a little distance from the fire.
70. (d) 'Disappeared down the hill' means to walk down the hill. Hence, option (d) is correct.
71. (a) This sentence implies that the crew member was bold and adventurous.
72. (c) 'Huddling' means 'being close together'.